

Install R and RStudio

Before starting the tutorials, you need to install two programs:

1. **R** — the programming language we will use.
2. **RStudio Desktop** — an easier interface for writing and running R code.

Important: Install **R** first, then install **RStudio**.

Install Links

- [R download](#) — available for Windows, Mac, and Linux
 - [RStudio Desktop download](#) — available for Windows, Mac, and Linux
-

Install R

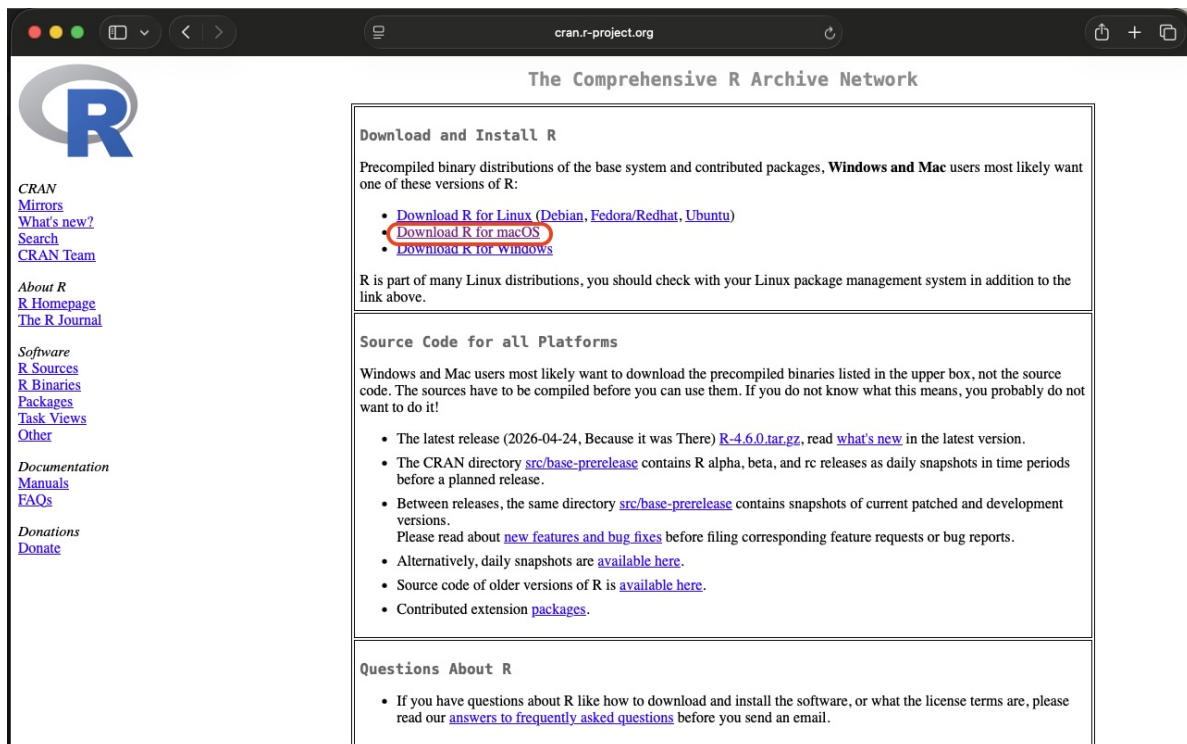
Mac

1. Go to the R download page:

<https://cran.r-project.org/>

2. Click:

Download R for macOS



3. Download the latest .pkg installer.

The file name will look something like:

R-4.x.x-arm64.pkg

or

R-4.x.x.pkg



CRAN
[Mirrors](#)
[What's new?](#)
[Search](#)
[CRAN Team](#)

About R
[R Homepage](#)
[The R Journal](#)

Software
[R Sources](#)
[R Binaries](#)
[Packages](#)
[Task Views](#)
[Other](#)

Documentation
[Manuals](#)
[FAQs](#)

Donations
[Donate](#)

R for macOS

This directory contains binaries for the base distribution and of R and packages to run on macOS. R and package binaries for R versions older than 4.0.0 are only available from the [CRAN archive](https://cran-archive.r-project.org) so users of such versions should adjust the CRAN mirror setting (<https://cran-archive.r-project.org>) accordingly.

Note: Although we take precautions when assembling binaries, please use the normal precautions with downloaded executables.

R 4.6.0 "Because it was There" released on 2026/04/24

Please check the integrity of the downloaded package by checking the signature:

```
pkgutil --check-signature R-4.6.0-arm64.pkg
```

in the *Terminal* application. If Apple tools are not available you can check the SHA1 checksum of the downloaded image:

```
openssl sha1 R-4.6.0-arm64.pkg
```

Latest release:

For Apple silicon (M1,2,...) Macs:

R-4.6.0-arm64.pkg

SHA1-sum: 8377206c58a0c420122f3693a76422e3303bda0c
 (ca. 101MB, notarized and signed)

R 4.6.0 binary for macOS 14 (**Sonoma**) and higher for arm64 Macs, signed and notarized packages.

Contains R 4.6.0 framework, R.app GUI 1.83, Tcl/Tk 8.6.12 X11 libraries and Texinfo 7.3. The latter two components are optional and can be omitted when choosing "custom install", they are only needed if you want to use the `tcltk` R package or build package documentation from sources.

If installing from the *Downloads* folder you must allow the Apple Installer access to that directory. Denying the access will result in you not being able to install any software from there and then you must move the file to a location that is not private such as your home folder.

Note: the use of X11 (including `tcltk`) requires [XQuartz](#) (version 2.8.5 or later). Always re-install XQuartz when upgrading your macOS to a new major version.

This release uses Xcode 26.0 (the same LLVM toolchain up to 26.3) and GNU Fortran 14.2. If you wish to compile R packages which contain Fortran code, you may need to download the corresponding GNU Fortran compiler from <https://mac.R-project.org/tools>. Any external libraries and tools are expected to live in `/opt/R/arm64`.

For older Intel Macs:

R-4.6.0-x86_64.pkg

SHA1-sum: e8426cd167b27e83597edcd95da828228b701a
 (ca. 104MB, notarized and signed)

R 4.6.0 binary for macOS 11 (**Big Sur**) and higher, signed and notarized packages.

Contains R 4.6.0 framework, R.app GUI 1.83, Tcl/Tk 8.6.12 X11 libraries and Texinfo 7.3. The latter two components are optional and can be omitted when choosing "custom install", they are only needed if you want to use the `tcltk` R package or build package documentation from sources.

If installing from the *Downloads* folder you must allow the Apple Installer access to that directory. Denying the access will result in you not being able to install any software from there and then you must move the file to a location that is not private such as your home folder.

Note: the use of X11 (including `tcltk`) requires [XQuartz](#) (version 2.8.5 or later). Always re-install XQuartz when upgrading your macOS to a new major version.

This release uses Xcode 14.2 and GNU Fortran 14.2. If you wish to compile R packages which contain Fortran code, you may need to download the corresponding GNU Fortran compiler from <https://mac.R-project.org/tools>. Any external libraries and tools are expected to live in `/opt/R/x86_64`.

Choose the appropriate installer for your Mac (M1/M2 or Intel).

4. Open the downloaded .pkg file and follow the installation instructions.
5. When the installation is complete, you can verify that R is installed by opening the Terminal and typing:

```
R --version
```

You should see the version of R that you installed.

Windows

1. Go to the R download page:

<https://cran.r-project.org/>

2. Click:

Download R for Windows



[CRAN](#)
[Mirrors](#)
[What's new?](#)
[Search](#)
[CRAN Team](#)

[About R](#)
[R Homepage](#)
[The R Journal](#)

[Software](#)
[R Sources](#)
[R Binaries](#)
[Packages](#)
[Task Views](#)
[Other](#)

[Documentation](#)
[Manuals](#)
[FAQs](#)

[Donations](#)
[Donate](#)

The Comprehensive R Archive Network

Download and Install R

Precompiled binary distributions of the base system and contributed packages, **Windows and Mac** users most likely want one of these versions of R:

- [Download R for Linux \(Debian, Fedora/Redhat, Ubuntu\)](#)
- [Download R for macOS](#)
- [Download R for Windows](#)

R is part of many Linux distributions, you should check with your Linux package management system in addition to the link above.

Source Code for all Platforms

Windows and Mac users most likely want to download the precompiled binaries listed in the upper box, not the source code. The sources have to be compiled before you can use them. If you do not know what this means, you probably do not want to do it!

- The latest release (2026-04-24, Because it was There) [R-4.6.0.tar.gz](#), read [what's new](#) in the latest version.
- The CRAN directory [src/base-prerelease](#) contains R alpha, beta, and rc releases as daily snapshots in time periods before a planned release.
- Between releases, the same directory [src/base-prerelease](#) contains snapshots of current patched and development versions. Please read about [new features](#) and [bug fixes](#) before filing corresponding feature requests or bug reports.
- Alternatively, daily snapshots are [available here](#).
- Source code of older versions of R is [available here](#).
- Contributed extension [packages](#).

3. Click:

base



[CRAN](#)
[Mirrors](#)
[What's new?](#)
[Search](#)
[CRAN Team](#)

[About R](#)
[R Homepage](#)
[The R Journal](#)

[Software](#)
[R Sources](#)
[R Binaries](#)
[Packages](#)
[Task Views](#)
[Other](#)

[Documentation](#)
[Manuals](#)
[FAQs](#)

[Donations](#)
[Donate](#)

R for Windows

Subdirectories:

- [base](#)
- [contrib](#)
- [old contrib](#)
- [Rtools](#)

Binaries for base distribution. This is what you want to [install R for the first time](#).
Binaries of contributed CRAN packages (for R >= 4.0.x).
Binaries of contributed CRAN packages for outdated versions of R (for R < 4.0.x).
Tools to build R and R packages. This is what you want to build your own packages on Windows, or to build R itself.

Please do not submit binaries to CRAN. Package developers might want to contact Uwe Ligges directly in case of questions / suggestions related to Windows binaries.

You may also want to read the [R FAQ](#) and [R for Windows FAQ](#).

Note: CRAN does some checks on these binaries for viruses, but cannot give guarantees. Use the normal precautions with downloaded executables.

4. Click the link to download the latest version of R (e.g., R-4.x.x-win.exe).
5. Open the downloaded .exe file and follow the installation instructions.

Install RStudio

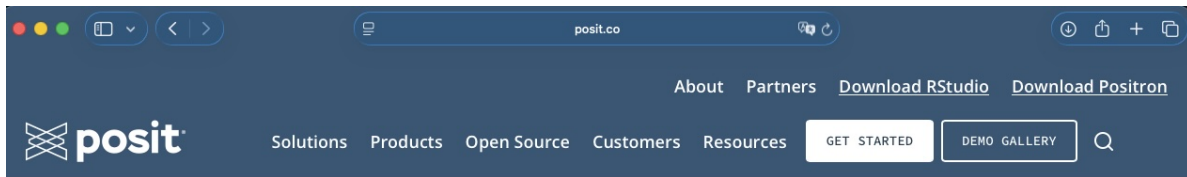
After installing R, install RStudio Desktop.

MAC

1. Go to the RStudio Desktop download page:

<https://posit.co/download/rstudio-desktop>

2. Click **Install Rstudio** and choose the Mac version.



started with RStudio on [Posit Cloud for free](#). If you're a professional data scientist looking to download RStudio and also need common enterprise features, don't hesitate to [book a call with us](#).

Want to learn about core or advanced workflows in RStudio? Explore the [RStudio User Guide](#) or the [Getting Started](#) section.

[Try Positron](#), the new code editor for data science from the creators of RStudio, built for the next generation of data science workflows with R and Python.

1: Install R

RStudio requires R 3.6.0+. Choose a version of R that matches your computer's operating system.

R is not a Posit product. By clicking on the link below to download and install R, you are leaving the Posit website. Posit disclaims any obligations and all liability with respect to R and the R website.

DOWNLOAD AND INSTALL R

2: Install RStudio

Choose macOS version

Choose macOS version

macOS 14+ (macOS 14 and higher)

macOS 10.12 - 13 (macOS 13 and earlier)

2: Install RS

macOS 14+ (macOS 14 and

DOWNLOAD RSTUDIO DESKTO

Size: 729.44 MB | [SHA-256: B](#)
2026.05.0+218 | Released: 20

3. Click the `DOWNLOAD RSTUDIO DESKTOP FOR MACOS ++` button.
4. Open the downloaded `.dmg` file from your Downloads folder.
5. Drag the RStudio icon into the Applications folder.
6. Open RStudio from your Applications folder.

Windows / PC

1. Go to the RStudio Desktop download page:

<https://posit.co/download/rstudio-desktop>

2. Download the Windows installer.

The file name will look something like:

`RStudio-202x.xx.x-xxx.exe`

Open the downloaded `.exe` file.

4. Follow the installation steps using the default options.

5. Open RStudio from the Start Menu.

Alternatively, you can directly download the Windows installer using this link:

<https://download1.rstudio.org/electron/windows/RStudio-2026.05.0-218.exe>

The file name will look something like:

`RStudio-202x.xx.x-xxx.exe`

1. Open the downloaded .exe file.
2. Follow the installation steps using the default options.
3. Open RStudio from the Start Menu.

Setup R and Rmd files to be opened in RStudio

After installing R and RStudio, you may want to set up your computer so that R and Rmd files automatically open in RStudio when you double-click them.

Mac

1. Find an R or Rmd file on your computer (e.g., in your Downloads folder).
2. Right-click the file and select **Get Info**.
3. In the “Get Info” window, find the “Open with:” section.
4. Click the dropdown menu and select **RStudio**.
5. Click the **Change All...** button to apply this setting to all R or Rmd files.
6. Confirm the change when prompted.

Windows

1. Find an R or Rmd file on your computer (e.g., in your Downloads folder).
2. Right-click the file and select **Open with > Choose another app**.
3. In the “How do you want to open this file?” window, select **RStudio**.
4. Check the box that says **Always use this app to open .R/.Rmd files**.
5. Click **OK** to apply the change.